

TAB 16



Board of Education Report

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File #: Res-018-22/23, Version: 1

Dr. Rivas, Mr. Schmerelson - LAUSD Support for Expanding Racial and Ethnic Categories in the 2030 Census and the Inclusion of a Specific Armenian Checkbox (Res-018-22/23) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Los Angeles Unified School District serves the largest community of Armenian Americans in the United States, and meaningful and comprehensive data on the Armenian population of Los Angeles, California is currently lacking;

Whereas, Armenian American students, and other student populations, continue to be invisible and underserved within U.S. public schools as immigrants, refugees and English Language Learners;

Whereas, The federal Office of Management and Budget recently released a new draft questionnaire for the 2030 Census that includes a new Middle East and North African (MENA) category with subcategories such as Lebanese, Syrian, Iranian, and other populations that are currently classified under the White Census category, and are therefore minimized as a distinct population;

Whereas, Armenian Americans constitute a transnational group across MENA and are historically one of the largest and most impacted groups of immigrants in the U.S. from the MENA region;

Whereas, Armenian Americans overwhelmingly support Census classification for their community and have been pushing for the inclusion of an Armenian checkbox in the U.S. Census questionnaire for many decades; and

Whereas, The inclusion of the MENA category and a specific Armenian checkbox within the MENA category of the 2030 Census would provide the District with more accurate data on all of its students, which would ultimately bring more educational resources and funding for the District to support underserved student populations; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District fully supports the inclusion of the MENA category in the 2030 Census, and the inclusion of a specific Armenian checkbox as a MENA subcategory, and urges the United States Office of Management and Budget to adopt this recommendation;

Resolved further, That the District expresses its support for the efforts of the Armenian National Committee of America Western Region, Armenian American Action Network and other organizations that are advocating for the inclusion of the MENA category and an Armenian checkbox in the 2030 U.S. Census; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District directs the Superintendent to send a letter to the Office of Management and Budget expressing the District's support for the inclusion of an Armenian checkbox under the proposed MENA category in the 2030 Census and explaining the importance of this inclusion for the Armenian American Students of LAUSD

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and Armenian American community of Los Angeles and the U.S. as a whole.